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Hiring Committee
McKinney Public Library
City of McKinney
401 E. Virginia Street, McKinney, TX 75069

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Technician position in Community Engagement with the McKinney Public Library. Planning programs, lining up the people who make them happen, promoting them, running them, and then finding out whether they worked is what my job already consists of. The programs happen to be fundraising campaigns rather than library programming, but the sequence is the same one your posting describes.

My title is Direct Mail Production Manager at Young Americans for Liberty, where I run printed fundraising campaigns from concept through mail date. One campaign might be a letter going out to the whole donor file, the next a proposal prepared for a single major donor, the next the invitation set for a conference, and most months several of them are moving at once. I design the schedule, coordinate the outside vendors and the internal departments producing each piece, hold every project to its date, and produce the promotional material that goes with it.

Your duties include evaluating current program and outreach models, and that is where I could be useful soonest, because evaluating outreach is already half of what I do. Everything we send gets measured afterward. How a conference invitation performed against the one before it, which fundraising letter earned a response and which did not, which audiences were worth going back to. That is the work that decides what we run again and what we retire.

I keep that history rather than trusting anyone to remember it. I manage the archive of every printed piece we produce, and I designed the SQL database behind it, set a consistent record for each piece covering mail code, campaign, date, format, audience and vendor, cataloged several campaign years against that standard, and built a searchable interface over the top, so the whole department can see what has been tried and how it did. I have built two public websites on my own time as well: the Free Knowledge Library, a digital library of political literature drawn from across the ideological spectrum, where I designed the site, the database and the classification scheme and built the catalog readers search; and StateTrack, which publishes state campaign finance records for all fifty states.

The public-facing side is familiar too. At the University of Austin I was the on-site point of contact for visitor tours of the campus library, hosting guests and answering their questions about the collections, and I handled the intake of donated books the university was building that library from, including a complete set of the *Harvard Classics*. I coordinated donor events with internal departments and outside partners, and earlier I ran event registration, check-in and on-site logistics for conferences serving up to a thousand attendees. Before that I staffed the public service window at Chapman University’s Fowler School of Law as the first person students talked to.

I am building toward this as a career rather than sampling it. I have begun the ALA’s Library Support Staff Certification, and I begin a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring, with a master’s in library and information science to follow. I should say plainly that I am able to relocate. I am in Austin now, and I am willing to move anywhere in Texas a position requires.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about the role.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie